

SECOND WORLD WAR, THE CRIPPS MISSION & QUIT INDIA (1939–1942)

UNCONSULTED BELLIGERENCY AND THE → AUGUST OFFER: PROMISE AND → INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA: SEQUENCE AND → CRIPPS ARRIVAL AND THE → CRIPPS SCHEME: OPT-OUT AND → BRITISH WARTIME CONTROL AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 UNCONSULTED BELLIGERENCY AND THE RESPONSE CHAIN

UNCONSULTED BELLIGERENCY AND THE RESPONSE CHAIN

3 SEP 1939

VICEROY DECLARES INDIA A BELLIGERENT, NO CONSULTATION

OCT-NOV 1939

CONGRESS MINISTRIES RESIGN

22 DEC 1939

LEAGUE DELIVERANCE DAY

MAR 1940

3 SEP 1939 → Viceroy declares India a belligerent, no consultation

OCT-NOV 1939 → Congress ministries resign

22 DEC 1939 → League Deliverance Day → MAR 1940 → Lahore Resolution

RULE → three connected but separately dated stages.

MUST REMEMBER: India was declared at war on 3 September 1939; the August Offer, Individual

CORE CLAIM

- 3 SEP 1939 → Viceroy declares India a belligerent, no consultation
- OCT-NOV 1939 → Congress ministries resign

MECHANISM

- 22 DEC 1939 → League Deliverance Day → MAR 1940 → Lahore Resolution
- RULE → three connected but separately dated stages.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: India was declared at war on 3 September 1939; the August Offer, Individual
- Satyagraha, Cripps Mission of March-April 1942 and Quit India resolution of 8 August 1942 were different constitutional-political moments.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → three connected but separately dated stages.

01

STAGE 01 AUGUST OFFER: PROMISE AND MINORITY-CONSENT VETO

AUGUST OFFER

PROMISE AND MINORITY-CONSENT VETO

8 AUG 1940

EXPANDED, REPRESENTATIVE POST-WAR CONSTITUTION-MAKING BODY

NO CONSTITUTION WITHOUT MINORITY CONSENT (EFFECTIVE VETO)

NO IMMEDIATE NATIONAL GOVERNMENT OFFERED.

CORE CLAIM

8 AUG 1940 → AUGUST OFFER
PROMISE → expanded, representative post-war constitution-making body

MECHANISM

CONDITION → no constitution without minority consent (effective veto)
LIMIT → no immediate national government offered.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

8 AUG 1940 → AUGUST OFFER
PROMISE → expanded, representative post-war constitution-making body

CORE CLAIM

- 8 AUG 1940 → AUGUST OFFER
- PROMISE → expanded, representative post-war constitution-making body

MECHANISM

- CONDITION → no constitution without minority consent (effective veto)
- LIMIT → no immediate national government offered.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 8 AUG 1940 → AUGUST OFFER
- PROMISE → expanded, representative post-war constitution-making body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONDITION → no constitution without minority consent (effective veto).

02

STAGE 02 INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA: SEQUENCE AND LIMITED OBJECTIVE

INDIVIDUAL SATYAGRAHA

SEQUENCE AND LIMITED OBJECTIVE

17 OCT 1940

VINOBA BHAVE, FIRST SATYAGRAHI

JAWAHARLAL NEHRU, SECOND SATYAGRAHI

SELECTED INDIVIDUALS PUBLICLY ASSERT THE RIGHT TO OPPOSE THE

LIMITED ANTI-WAR FREE-SPEECH RIGHT, NOT MASS CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE.

17 OCT 1940 → Vinoba Bhave, first satyagrahi

NEXT → Jawaharlal Nehru, second satyagrahi

METHOD → selected individuals publicly assert the right to oppose the war

OBJECTIVE → limited anti-war free-speech right, not mass civil disobedience.

CORE CLAIM

- 17 OCT 1940 → Vinoba Bhave, first satyagrahi
- NEXT → Jawaharlal Nehru, second satyagrahi

MECHANISM

- METHOD → selected individuals publicly assert the right to oppose the war
- OBJECTIVE → limited anti-war free-speech right, not mass civil disobedience.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 17 OCT 1940 → Vinoba Bhave, first satyagrahi
- NEXT → Jawaharlal Nehru, second satyagrahi

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OBJECTIVE → limited anti-war free-speech right, not mass civil disobedience.

03

STAGE 03 CRIPPS ARRIVAL AND THE MARCH 1942 PROPOSALS

CRIPPS ARRIVAL AND THE MARCH 1942 PROPOSALS

MAR 1942

CRIPPS ARRIVES IN INDIA

LATE MAR 1942

PROPOSALS ANNOUNCED

DOMINION STATUS AFTER THE WAR + POST-WAR CONSTITUTION-MAKING BODY

NO CHANGE TO INDIA'S STATUS DURING THE WAR ITSELF.

MAR 1942 → Cripps arrives in India

LATE MAR 1942 → proposals announced

OFFER → Dominion status after the war + post-war constitution-making body

LIMIT → no change to India's status during the war itself.

CORE CLAIM

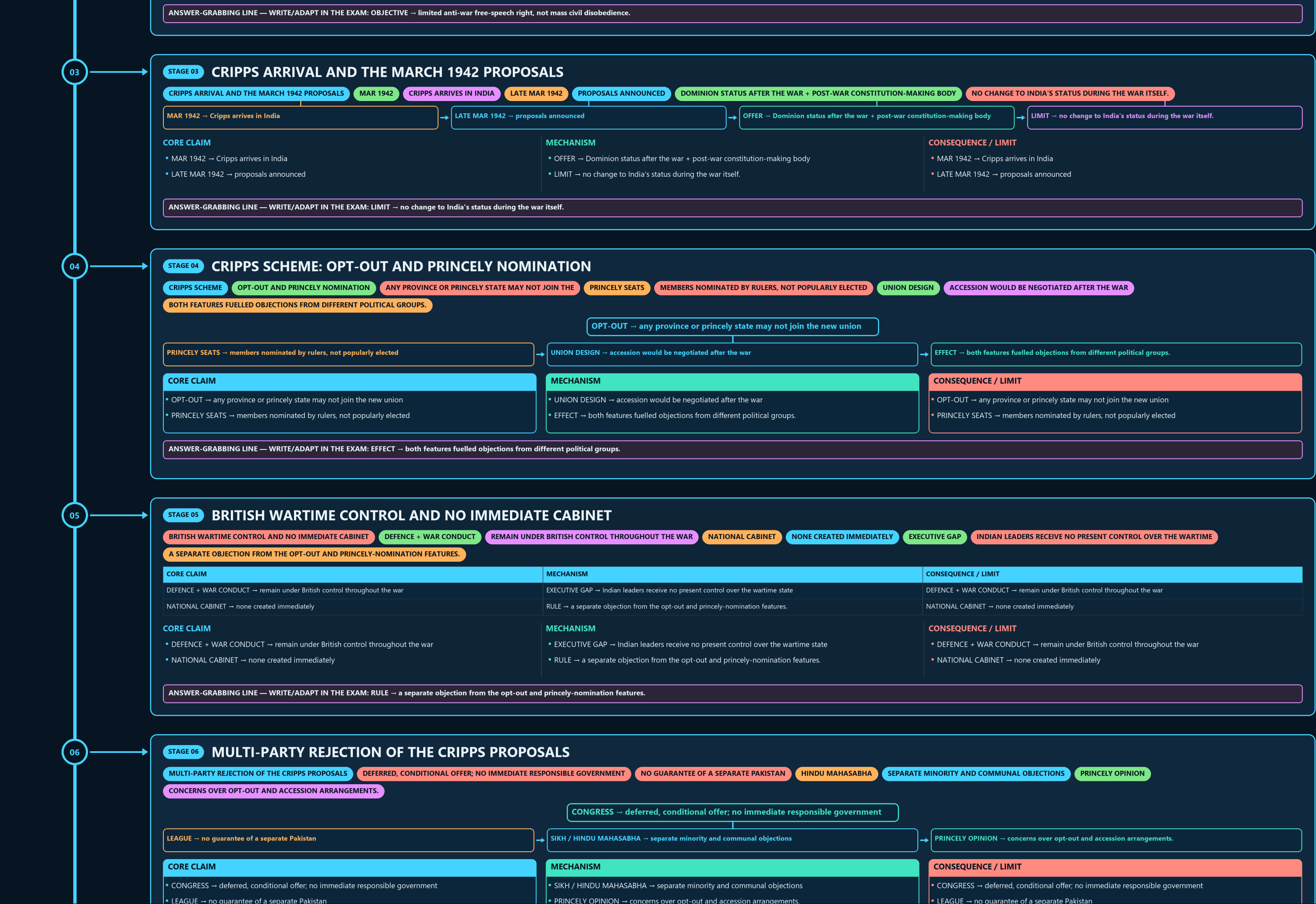
- MAR 1942 → Cripps arrives in India
- LATE MAR 1942 → proposals announced

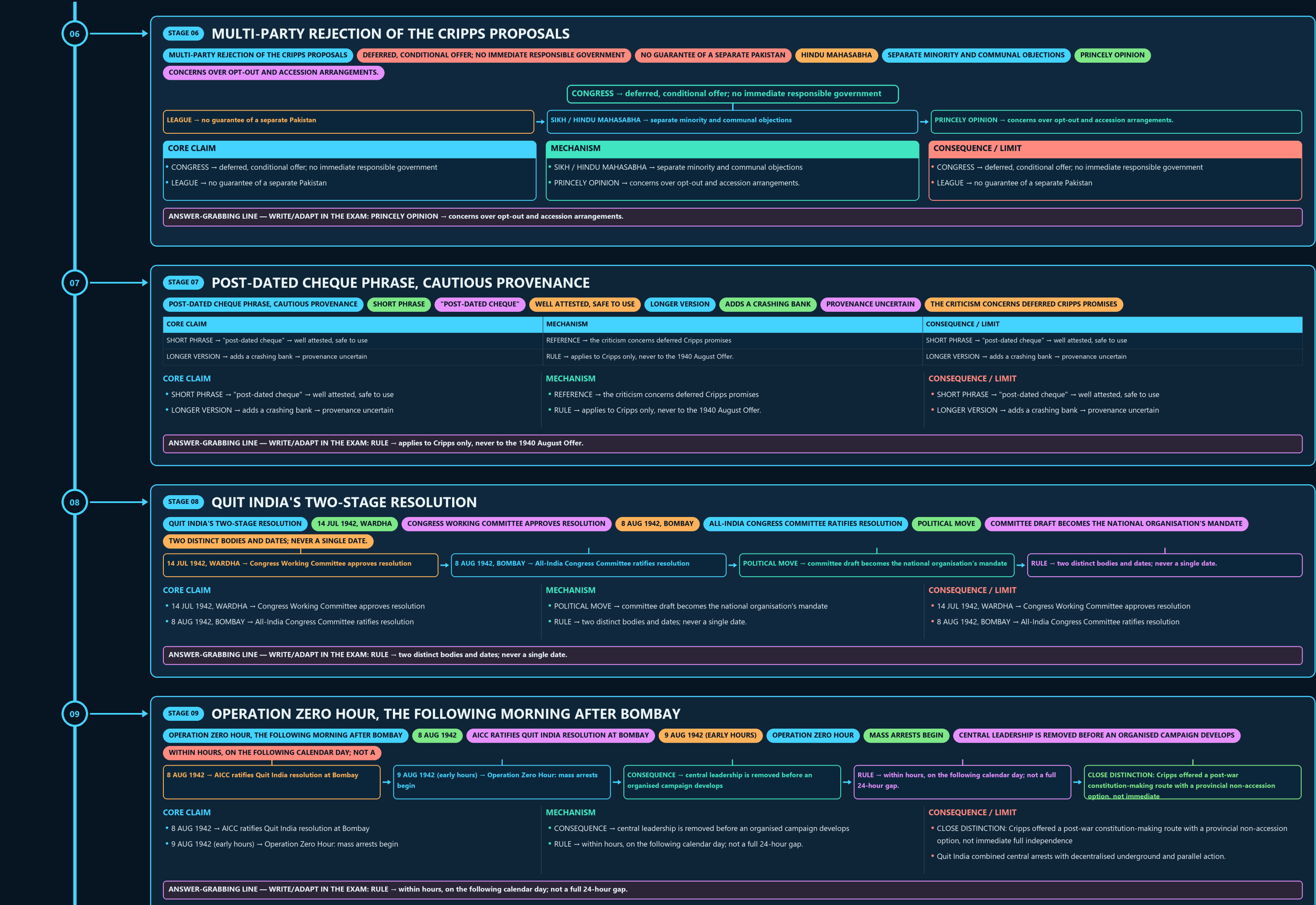
MECHANISM

- OFFER → Dominion status after the war + post-war constitution-making body
- LIMIT → no change to India's status during the war itself.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MAR 1942 → Cripps arrives in India
- LATE MAR 1942 → proposals announced





OPERATION ZERO HOUR, THE FOLLOWING MORNING AFTER BOMBAY

8 AUG 1942

AICC RATIFIES QUIT INDIA RESOLUTION AT BOMBAY

9 AUG 1942 (EARLY HOURS)

OPERATION ZERO HOUR

MASS ARRESTS BEGIN

CENTRAL LEADERSHIP IS REMOVED BEFORE AN ORGANISED CAMPAIGN DEVELOPS

WITHIN HOURS, ON THE FOLLOWING CALENDAR DAY; NOT A

8 AUG 1942 → AICC ratifies Quit India resolution at Bombay

9 AUG 1942 (early hours) → Operation Zero Hour: mass arrests begin

CONSEQUENCE → central leadership is removed before an organised campaign develops

RULE → within hours, on the following calendar day; not a full 24-hour gap.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Cripps offered a post-war constitution-making route with a provincial non-accession option. not immediate

CORE CLAIM

8 AUG 1942 → AICC ratifies Quit India resolution at Bombay

9 AUG 1942 (early hours) → Operation Zero Hour: mass arrests begin

MECHANISM

CONSEQUENCE → central leadership is removed before an organised campaign develops

RULE → within hours, on the following calendar day; not a full 24-hour gap.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Cripps offered a post-war constitution-making route with a provincial non-accession option, not immediate full independence

Quit India combined central arrests with decentralised underground and parallel action.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → within hours, on the following calendar day; not a full 24-hour gap.

STAGE 10

DO OR DIE, GOWALIA TANK AND UNDERGROUND RESISTANCE

DO OR DIE, GOWALIA TANK AND UNDERGROUND RESISTANCE

8 AUG 1942

GANDHI'S "DO OR DIE" CALL, BEFORE HIS ARREST

GOWALIA TANK, BOMBAY

ARUNA ASAF ALI HOISTS THE CONGRESS FLAG

USHA MEHTA'S CONGRESS RADIO

JAYAPRAKASH NARAYAN AND RAM MANOHAR LOHIA ORGANISE RESISTANCE.

EVIDENCE LIMIT

8 AUG 1942 → Gandhi's "Do or Die" call, before his arrest

GOWALIA TANK, BOMBAY → Aruna Asaf Ali hoists the Congress flag

UNDERGROUND → Usha Mehta's Congress Radio

UNDERGROUND → Jayaprakash Narayan and Ram Manohar Lohia organise resistance.

CORE CLAIM

8 AUG 1942 → Gandhi's "Do or Die" call, before his arrest

GOWALIA TANK, BOMBAY → Aruna Asaf Ali hoists the Congress flag

MECHANISM

UNDERGROUND → Usha Mehta's Congress Radio

UNDERGROUND → Jayaprakash Narayan and Ram Manohar Lohia organise resistance.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Official repression records, underground communications, local rebellions and the

1943 Bengal famine context qualify both leaderless-chaos and perfectly coordinated-revolution narratives.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Official repression records, underground communications, local rebellions and the 1943 Bengal famine context qualify both leaderless-chaos and perfectly coordinated-revolution narratives.

STAGE 11

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS, SOCIAL BASE AND RESULTS

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS, SOCIAL BASE AND RESULTS

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS

BALLIA; JATIYA SARKAR (TAMLUK); PRATI SARKAR (SATARA)

STUDENTS, WORKERS, PEASANTS; REGIONALLY VARIABLE INTENSITY

LEAGUE ALOOF/OPOSED; CPI PEOPLE'S WAR LINE; MAHASABHA/PRINCES DISTANT

SUPPRESSED WITHIN MONTHS; NO SOLO INDEPENDENCE; LASTING SENTIMENT SHOWN.

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS → Ballia; Jatiya Sarkar (Tamluk); Prati Sarkar (Satara)

BASE → students, workers, peasants; regionally variable intensity

ALIGNMENTS → League aloof/opposed; CPI People's War line; Mahasabha/princes distant

RESULTS → suppressed within months; no solo independence; lasting sentiment shown.

CORE CLAIM

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS → Ballia; Jatiya Sarkar (Tamluk); Prati Sarkar (Satara)

BASE → students, workers, peasants; regionally variable intensity

MECHANISM

ALIGNMENTS → League aloof/opposed; CPI People's War line; Mahasabha/princes distant

RESULTS → suppressed within months; no solo independence; lasting sentiment shown.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

PARALLEL GOVERNMENTS → Ballia; Jatiya Sarkar (Tamluk); Prati Sarkar (Satara)

BASE → students, workers, peasants; regionally variable intensity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULTS → suppressed within months; no solo independence; lasting sentiment shown.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

INDIA'S STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE PRESENTS THE WAR YEARS AS

WHICH IMPERIAL CLAIMS TO DEFEND DEMOCRACY CLASHED WITH THE

THE CONGRESS RESPONSE WAS NOT ISOLATIONIST

IT OBJECTED TO BEING COMMITTED TO WAR WITHOUT A

THE AUGUST OFFER RETAINED THE VICEROY'S CONTROL AND GAVE

THE COLONIAL PATTERN OF USING COMMUNAL SAFEGUARDS TO BLOCK

THE CRIPPS PROPOSALS RECOGNISED CONSTITUTION-MAKING BUT WEAKENED NATIONAL UNITY

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

India's Struggle for Independence presents the war years as a decisive phase in

which imperial claims to defend democracy clashed with the denial of Indian self-government.

The Congress response was not isolationist

it objected to being committed to war without a declaration that India would be free and without an immediate national government.

ADVANCED DEBATE

The August Offer retained the Viceroy's control and gave minorities a practical veto, strengthening

the colonial pattern of using communal safeguards to block national transfer of power.

The Cripps proposals recognised constitution-making but weakened national unity by allowing British Indian provinces not to accept the

princely-state representation remained controlled by rulers rather than popular election.

LEGACY / NUANCE

The arrest of the entire top leadership on 9 August 1942 produced a decentralised upsurge

local activists, students, workers, peasants and underground socialists carried the struggle forward.

The movement included strikes, processions, attacks on railways and telegraphs,

disruption of police stations, underground bulletins and clandestine radio broadcasts.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.